

Usability goals

- Effective to use
- Efficient to use
- Safe to use
- Have good utility
- Easy to learn
- Easy to remember how to use

Usability Goals

- **Effectiveness:**
 - Generally, how good a product is at doing what it is supposed to do. Is the product capable of allowing people to learn, carry out their work efficiently, access the information they need, or buy the goods they want?
 - Ask usability questions in a detailed way: How long will it take a user to figure out how to use the most basic functions for the new web browser? How can users capitalize on their prior experience? How long will it take for users to learn all the functions?

Usability Goals

- **Efficiency:**
 - Efficiency refers to the way a product supports users in carrying out their tasks. Eg. Listening to messages via a minimal number of steps.
 - Question: Once users have learned how to use a product to carry out their tasks, can they sustain a high level of productivity?

Usability Goals

- Safety:
 - Protecting the user from dangerous conditions and undesirable situations. Eg. Devices such as x-ray machines or toxic chemicals – operators can interact and control the system remotely.
 - Also, refers to perceived fears users might have of the consequences of making errors.
 - Prevent users from making serious errors by reducing the risk of wrong keys/buttons being mistakenly pressed.
 - Providing users with various error recovery mechanism.

Usability Goals

- Utility:
 - The extent to which the product provides the right kind of functionality so that users can do what they need or want to do. Ex. Accounting software package that provides a powerful tool for accountants is high utility, and a drawing tools that doesn't allow for free form art, but restricted to selecting polygons and using a mouse.
 - Question: Does the product provide an appropriate set of functions that will enable users to carry out all their tasks in the way they want to?

Usability Goals

- **Learnability**

- Refers to how easy the system is to learn to use it. People don't like spending a long time to learn how to carry out tasks, instead want to get started right away and carry out tasks with minimal effort.
- People are prepared to spend a longer learning time for more complex systems that are used for specialized tasks. Eg. Web authoring tools, IDEs etc.
- Question: Is it possible for users to work out how to use the product by exploring the interface and trying things out? How hard will be to learn the whole set of functionality this way?

Usability Goals

- Memorability:
 - Refers to how easy a product is to remember how to use, once learned. Applications used infrequently, one should be able to remember the steps of use rapidly. Operations required to be learned should not be obscure, illogical, or poorly sequenced.
 - Question: What kinds of interface support have been provided to help users remember how to carry out tasks, especially for products and operations they use infrequently?